



The power of deadlines

Teaching and mentoring



Agenda

- Vocabulary: Deadlines
- Reading: Two scenarios
- Video: The psychology of deadlines
- Grammar: Causative structures



Discussion

- Read each person's problem with deadlines.
 - Which of these problems do you have with setting and meeting deadlines? Why?
 - What can you do to overcome these problems?
- A. I often don't start working until the deadline gets closer.*
 - B. I find it difficult to manage my time when I have multiple deadlines around the same time.*
 - C. I struggle to meet soft deadlines more than hard deadlines.*
 - D. I feel discouraged when I miss a deadline and find it difficult to start working again.*
 - E. I feel stressed when I work under the pressure of deadlines.*
 - F. I have trouble setting realistic deadlines.*



Vocabulary

Fill in the blanks with the words in the box.

attention calendar complex fixed motivated procrastination productive realistic self-imposed

Types:

- soft = flexible, 1 self-imposed
- hard = 2 fixed, set by others

Benefits:

- get us to complete tasks and projects
focus our 3 attention
- 4 motivate us
- stop 5 procrastination

- help us to become more 6 productive and perform better

Strategies:

- Plan carefully.
- Break down 7 complex tasks.
- Assign a 8 realistic amount of time for each part.
- Put time slots in your 9 calendar.



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Lektor

Vocabulary

Expression	Meaning	Example Sentence
Take on too many tasks or responsibilities	to accept or agree to do more work than you can realistically handle	<i>I always take on too many tasks before exams and end up feeling stressed.</i>
Burn the midnight oil / pull an all-nighter	to stay up very late (or all night) working or studying	<i>She burned the midnight oil to get her presentation ready for the morning meeting.</i>
Approach a deadline	to get closer to the time when something must be finished	<i>As we approach the deadline, everyone's working faster to get the report done.</i>
Delay the start / beginning	to postpone starting something	<i>They delayed the start of the project because the budget wasn't approved yet.</i>
Avoid / procrastinate / put off until later	to delay doing something that needs to be done, usually because it's unpleasant or difficult	<i>He tends to procrastinate and put off writing his essays until the last minute.</i>
Focus on one thing at a time / tackle one task at a time	to concentrate on completing a single task before starting another	<i>I try to tackle one task at a time instead of multitasking—it helps me stay calm and organized.</i>



The power of deadlines

- **Nova** is a freelance editor working on a new course book for a publishing company. He's working with an editorial assistant and three different authors. The publishing company gave Nova a deadline for the submission of the final drafts of each unit of the course book, setting the final submission date two weeks before the publisher's deadline to allow for possible delays. He also asked the editorial assistant to set reminders for each interim due date in their shared calendar. The authors began writing immediately, but it quickly became clear that they would need more time on the first drafts than planned. So, the schedule was updated to make the first draft phase longer and the others shorter. However, by the second draft, the authors were still struggling to meet the interim deadlines. Nova notified the publishing company to see if the final deadline could be postponed.
- **Lauren** is a psychologist with over 10 years of experience. She sees at least two clients a day and writes a weekly column for a psychology blog. She's also recently started a specialized training course. To complete the first module of the course, she has to submit an assignment in six weeks. She believes it will take four full days to complete the assignment. She's very busy over the next four weeks, but she sets reminders on her phone to work on the assignment for four days after that. She has always tracked her time while writing her blog posts, and she knows it usually takes her almost five hours to write each one. So, she plans to skip posting to her blog during those two weeks. After the first day of working on the assignment, Lauren realizes that she will need more than four days to complete it, and she's wondering how she'll find the time to get it done.



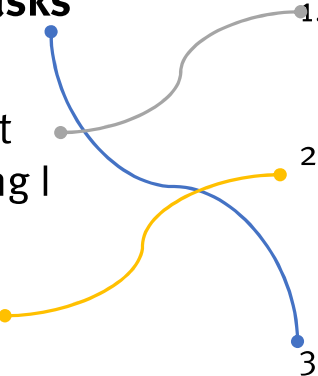
Video

1. According to Parkinson's Law, tasks will take as long as the amount of _____ people are given.
2. Deadlines help reduce procrastination by encouraging people to _____ more effectively.
3. The _____ **effect** explains why incomplete tasks remain in our minds.
4. _____ suggests we become more focused as the deadline gets closer.
5. Setting _____ can make team members feel overwhelmed or burned out.
6. To avoid confusion, avoid vague phrases and be more _____ when giving deadlines.
7. Breaking large projects into smaller tasks can help make the work more _____.
8. For creative work, it can be better to use _____ rather than hard deadlines.



Lektor

Grammar

- A. I need piece and quiet to **get all my tasks done**.
- B. I'd choose level three difficulty so that the staff would **get me to do** everything I had to do.
- C. If the task is due so soon, I'll **have my team address** it ASAP.
1. make someone do something by convincing them
 2. instruct someone to do something (because you have authority)
 3. finish something
- 



Causative structures

Structure	Example	Meaning
have someone do something	<i>I had my assistant book the meeting.</i>	I arranged for my assistant to do it.
get someone to do something	<i>I got my colleague to finish the report.</i>	I persuaded or convinced them to do it.
get something done	<i>I got the report done before the deadline.</i>	The task was completed (by me or by someone else).

- have someone do something → more formal / neutral
- get someone to do something → involves persuasion
- get something done → focuses on the result or completion



Discussion

- A. When you're under pressure, do you usually **get someone to help you** or try to do everything yourself?
- B. Have you ever **had someone do** part of a project for you to meet a tight deadline? What happened?
- C. What's something you really need to **get done** this week, and what's stopping you?
- D. In your team or at work, who usually **gets people to** meet their deadlines? How?
- E. When was the last time you **got something done** earlier than expected? How did you manage your time?
- F. Do you think good managers should **have people do** tasks for them, or do things themselves to set an example?



That's all, folks!

